

What people are starting to search for.

You type a few keywords. Six small steps later you know which video topics around them are rising in Google search, measured on the quiet months so a single spike can't fool you. This guide walks through every step with a real example.

Don't chase the peak. Find the floor that's rising.

A video costs you days. This pipeline takes the words you would use to describe your niche and asks Google, month by month for four years, whether more people want that than a year ago.

It ends with a verdict per topic. This is a real result, from the seed keywords "opencode", "codex" and "claude code":

TOPIC	BIGGEST KEYWORD	SEARCHES / MONTH	YOY	VERDICT
Claude Code	claude code	550,000	+406%	rising
Codex AI coding tool	codex	368,000	+641%	rising
OpenCode	opencode	110,000	+2,470%	rising
Codex app on Windows and Mac	codex windows	1,900	+7,542%	rising
Codex Python	codex python	210	+23%	rising
Codex Gigas, and 17 more	codex gigas devil	6,600	–	skipped: unrelated

"Codex Gigas" is a medieval manuscript. Google suggested it because the seed "codex" has two lives. Step 4 caught it.

THE PRINCIPLE BEHIND IT

A search is an honest signal. Its quiet months are the honest part.

Nobody searches to look smart. But one news week can double a year's average. So the pipeline compares the three quietest months of this year with the three quietest of last year: the demand that is there on a boring day.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Seed keyword A word or short phrase you give Google to show it where to look.

Keyword Anything people type into Google's search box, such as "claude code tutorial".

Floor The average of a year's three quietest months: the demand that is always there.

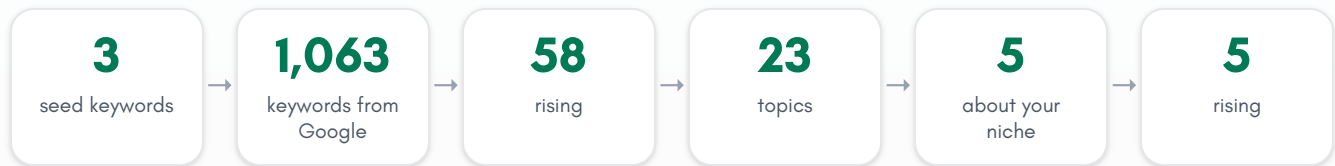
Searches a month How often people typed the keyword into Google in a month. Rounded, so read it as a size.

Six steps. Each one asks one question.

Every step takes the previous step's answer, does one small thing, and saves what went in and what came out. The colour tells you where the answer comes from.

1	Google	Keyword ideas	What do people search for around my seed keywords?
2	Rule	Search trends	Is each keyword rising, flat or shrinking?
3	Rule	Rising keywords	Which ones are rising, with enough searches to trust?
4	LLM	Group into topics	Which video topics are those keywords about?
5	Rule	Biggest gainers	Which topics gained the most searches?
6	Rule	Scoreboard	Which topics are rising?

The same run, as a funnel



Real numbers from the run on the previous page. Most of the work is throwing things away.

WHERE PIPELINE 4 GOES FROM HERE

These six steps answer "is it rising?". Pipeline 4 runs the same steps and then searches YouTube to check whether each rising topic is also **repeatable**: whether it has worked for many channels. This pipeline alone tells you where demand is growing. It does not yet tell you whether videos on it do well.

THREE KINDS OF STEP

Google steps fetch facts. **Rule** steps are plain arithmetic you can check by hand. **LLM** steps use an AI model only for language judgement, such as "are these two phrases the same topic?", and never for numbers.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Seed keyword A word or short phrase you give Google to show it where to look.

Topic What a video is about. One topic covers many keywords and wordings.

LLM A large language model: an AI that reads and writes text, like ChatGPT or Claude.

Pick seed keywords like you'd aim a flashlight.

A seed keyword only tells Google where to look. It does not have to be the answer. The later steps throw away what doesn't fit.

RULE OF THUMB

WHAT IT MEANS

Short and noun-like

One to three words that name a thing: **claude code** , **ai agents** . Not a whole question. Google does the expanding for you.

One theme per run

Two or three seeds the same viewer would care about. Start a new run for the next theme.

Avoid words with two lives

See the example below.

Where to find them

The search terms in your YouTube Studio analytics, the tools and problems of your niche, and the keywords a previous run turned up.

A real example of a seed gone wrong

The run in this guide used the seed **codex** , meaning the AI coding tool. But a codex is also a medieval manuscript and a Warhammer rule book. Google blends all seeds into one answer, and this is who got the space:



From the file 01_a_seeds_to_keywords.json of the run. One ambiguous seed crowded out the other two.

WHAT THIS TEACHES

A bad seed rarely gives a wrong verdict. It gives a blind spot.

The manuscripts were caught and skipped in step 4, so the scoreboard is still right. The cost is what you never saw: almost no keywords about Claude Code. The fix is a sharper seed, such as **openai codex** , or a run for each tool.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Seed keyword A word or short phrase you give Google to show it where to look.

Keyword Planner Google's free tool for advertisers. It shows how often each keyword is searched, month by month.

What do people search for on Google?

Your seed keywords go to Google's Keyword Planner, the tool advertisers use. It answers with the related things people type into Google, and how many times a month, for each of the last 48 months.

GOES IN

opencode
codex
claude code

Three seed keywords, typed by you.



COMES OUT

claude code	550,000 a month
codex	368,000 a month
opencode	110,000 a month
codex gigas	18,100 a month
open code download	880 a month

and 1,058 more, each with 48 months of history.

WHY IT WORKS

A search is an honest signal.

Nobody searches to look smart. People type what they actually want, when nobody is watching. And advertisers spend real money based on these numbers, so Google has a reason to keep them right.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- The numbers are rounded into steps (880, 1,000, 1,300 ...). Read them as sizes, not exact counts.
- It is Google search, not YouTube search. It shows that people want an answer, not yet that they want a video.
- Your seeds go to Google together and come back as one mixed list. Google does not give each seed a fair share. In this run 825 of the 1,063 keywords had "codex" in them and only 1 had "claude code", so the run learned almost nothing about Claude Code. Page 4 shows how to avoid that.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Keyword Planner Google's free tool for advertisers. It shows how often each keyword is searched, month by month.

Searches a month How often people typed the keyword into Google in a month. Rounded, so read it as a size.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.keyword_ideas "claude code"`

SAVED AS 01_a_... and 01_b_keyword_ideas.json

Is each keyword rising, flat or shrinking?

For every keyword, compare the last 12 months with the 12 months before. But don't compare the averages. Compare the **floor**: the average of the three quietest months of each year.

GOES IN

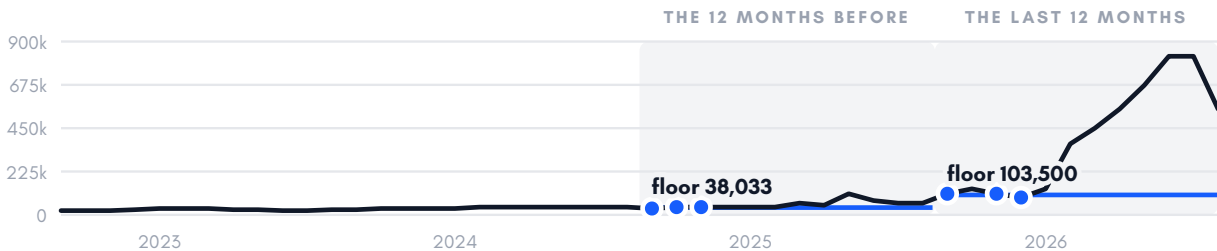
codex	48 months
codex gigas	48 months
codex sinaiticus	48 months

Each keyword with its monthly searches.

COMES OUT

codex	floor 38,033 → 103,500 rising
codex gigas	floor 13,900 → 13,900 flat
codex sinaiticus	floor 12,100 → 9,300 shrinking

Up 20% or more is rising. Down 20% or more is shrinking. Nothing a year ago is new.



Monthly Google searches for "codex". Blue dots: the three quietest months of each year. Blue line: their average, the floor.

WHY IT WORKS

Measure the quiet months, not the loud ones.

One news week can double a year's average. It cannot lift the three quietest months. The floor is the demand that is there on a boring day: the audience still around when your video comes out.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- It needs two years of history. Brand-new topics are labelled "new" instead of measured.
- The floor reacts slowly. A topic that took off two months ago can still read as flat.
- The 20% line is a judgement call. Google's rounding makes smaller changes unreadable anyway.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Floor The average of a year's three quietest months: the demand that is always there.

Trend Rising, flat, shrinking or new. It compares this year's floor with last year's.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.search_trends (needs no keys)`

SAVED AS `02_search_trends.json`

Which keywords are rising, with enough searches to trust?

A simple filter with three tests. A keyword goes on when it gets 200 or more searches a month, its trend is rising or new, and its year did not fall 20% or more.

GOES IN

1,063 keywords, each with the trend from step 2.



COMES OUT

58 keywords go on to step 4.

1,005 are dropped. Each one keeps the reason it was dropped, so you can check any keyword.

THE ARITHMETIC. A KEYWORD IS DROPPED AT THE FIRST TEST IT FAILS, IN THIS ORDER.

1,063 keywords came from Google in step 1

-	891	Too small. Under 200 searches a month.	"open code software": 20 a month	172 left
-	95	Big enough, but flat. Floor moved under 20%.	"codex gigas": floor unchanged	77 left
-	19	Big enough, but shrinking. Floor fell 20%+.	"codex sinaiticus": floor down 23%	58 left
-	0	Rising, but the year fell 20%+. None in this run.		58 left
=	58	Go on. Rising or new, with 200 or more searches a month.	"claude code", "opencode"	

WHY IT WORKS

Small numbers lie.

A keyword that goes from 10 to 30 searches is "up 200%" and means nothing. A minimum size removes that noise. And filtering here is free, while a YouTube search, in pipeline 4, costs quota.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- 200 searches is a judgement call. A tiny niche may need a lower bar. You can change it in config.py.
- It does not know what your channel is about. Rising keywords about medieval manuscripts pass too. The next step removes them.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Floor FROM STEP 2 The average of a year's three quietest months: the demand that is always there.

Trend FROM STEP 2 Rising, flat, shrinking or new. It compares this year's floor with last year's.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.rising_keywords` (needs no keys)

SAVED AS `03_rising_keywords.json`

Which video topics are those keywords about?

An AI model reads the rising keywords and groups the ones that are really the same video. It also flags the groups that are not worth a look: unrelated to your seeds, too broad, or just a brand name.

GOES IN

opencode
open code
open code download
codex gigas devil
warhammer 40k codex
and **53** more rising keywords.



COMES OUT

OpenCode · 4	search YouTube for keywords
Codex AI coding tool · 4 keywords	"codex ai"
Codex Gigas · 3 keywords	skipped: unrelated
Warhammer 40k codex books · 15	skipped: unrelated
The Codex · 1 keyword	skipped: too broad

23 topics, of which **18** are skipped.

WHY IT WORKS

A video answers a need, not a phrase.

People word one need in many ways. Grouping them means one YouTube search instead of nine. Telling the AI tool "Codex" from the manuscript "Codex Gigas" takes language judgement, which no simple rule can do. The guardrail: the model may only use keywords from the list. Anything it invents is thrown away.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- It is a judgement, so it can be wrong, and a different model may group differently. The reasons are saved, so check them.
- It is the one step in this pipeline you cannot verify with a calculator.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

LLM A large language model: an AI that reads and writes text, like ChatGPT or Claude.

Guardrail A check on the AI model: it may only pick from the real list it was given.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.group_into_topics` (one small LLM call)

SAVED AS 04_group_into_topics.json

Which topics gained the most searches?

The topics that were not skipped are ranked by how many searches a month their biggest keyword gained in a year. The top 10 are the ones to look at first, and the ones pipeline 4 would check on YouTube.

GOES IN

23 topics, **18** of them already skipped.

COMES OUT

Claude Code **+405,114** searches a month

Codex AI coding tool **+347,241**

OpenCode **+105,511**

Codex app on Windows and Mac **+2,074**

Codex Python **+41**

All **5** are worth a look.

WHY IT WORKS

Rank by searches gained, not by growth percent.

Growth of 2,000% from almost nothing is still almost nothing. Ranking by searches **gained**, in absolute numbers, puts the topics with the most new demand first. In pipeline 4 the same ranking decides which topics get a YouTube search, which costs quota.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- It favours big topics. In a broad run, a small niche topic may never make the top 10. Run narrower seeds to see it.
- A topic is judged by its single biggest keyword.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Searches gained This year's searches a month minus last year's, for a topic's biggest keyword.

Topic FROM STEP 4 What a video is about. One topic covers many keywords and wordings.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.choose_topics` (needs no keys)

SAVED AS 05_choose_topics.json

Which topics are rising?

The last step puts one row per topic on a scoreboard: its biggest keyword, that keyword's searches a month and trend, and the verdict.

GOES IN

The topics and their Google keywords.



COMES OUT

Claude Code	rising
OpenCode	rising
Codex Python	rising
Codex Gigas	skipped: unrelated

5 rising, 18 skipped.

WHY IT WORKS

A topic is judged by its biggest keyword.

Rising means that keyword's floor is up 20% or more on last year, it gets 200 or more searches a month, and the whole year did not fall. "Rising keywords" on the row says how many of the topic's keywords agree. When it is only a few, open the row and check the biggest keyword really is the topic.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- "Rising" means demand is growing. It does not say whether videos on it do well. That is the YouTube test, in pipeline 4.
- "Codex Python" is rising on 210 searches a month: rising, but tiny. Read the searches column with the verdict.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Verdict The pipeline's conclusion for a topic. It always comes with its reason.

Rising The floor is up 20% or more on last year, or the keyword is new.

Searches gained FROM STEP 5 This year's searches a month minus last year's, for a topic's biggest keyword.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.scoreboard` (needs no keys)

SAVED AS 06_scoreboard.json and scoreboard.csv

What this pipeline can't tell you.

It is a way to check your hunches against search data. It is not an oracle. Knowing where it is weak is what lets you trust it where it is strong.

LIMIT

WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

It only looks where you point it	It finds topics near your seeds. It cannot find a topic you had no words for. Pipeline 1 covers that: it starts from videos instead of words.
Google search is not YouTube	People google some things they would never watch, and watch things they would never google. Pipeline 4 adds the YouTube check.
It runs late on brand-new topics	Keyword data arrives monthly and the floor needs quiet months to rise. For something that launched last week, pipeline 1 is faster.
The thresholds are opinions	200 searches, 20%. They are named settings in config.py. Change one, run again, and see which verdicts move.
One country, one language	The default is the United States and English. Both are settings.

FIRST PRINCIPLE

A model you can't inspect, you can't improve.

Every step saves a file with a summary, what went in and what came out. When a verdict surprises you, open the run folder and walk back, file by file, to the step that caused it.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

config.py The settings file. Every number in this guide is a named setting in it.

Run One go of the pipeline. Each run gets its own folder, with one file per step.

RUN IT YOURSELF

One command.

Set it up once, then give it your seed keywords. A page opens in your browser that shows every step of the run.

```
cp .env.example .env          your LLM key
cp config.py.example config.py your niche
uv run pipeline_2_google_...analysis.py "claude code" run it
```

Google Ads access takes a short application. The README in the repo walks through it.